

THEVAKI BALAKRISHNAN

UX/UI Designer & Creative Director | Digital Product, Brand & Web

thevakimail@gmail.com | +44 7342 736804 | [Linkedin](#) | [Portfolio](#) | [NicheUX](#) | British Citizen · Open to Relocation

PROFILE

UX/UI Designer and Creative Director with 3+ years delivering digital products that measurably convert. Founder of NicheUX, an independent creative studio taking projects end-to-end — from UX research, wireframing, and information architecture through to custom code (React, TypeScript, Shopify Liquid, Framer) and full visual identity systems. Closes the gap between design, brand, and engineering, working directly in the browser as well as Figma for zero handoff loss and faster launches. Delivered a 133% conversion uplift, 642% growth in email signups, and 100/100 SEO scores for clients across four countries, alongside creative-director-level brand and event identity work reaching national audiences. Background in Digital Journalism sharpens content hierarchy, UX writing, and copy strategy.

EXPERIENCE

UX/UI Designer & Creative Director · [NicheUX](#)

Mar 2025 - Present

Independent UX & digital product studio — 5 live client projects across 4 countries

- Launched a zero-template Shopify Liquid e-commerce store for Bloom & Brew Coffee Co. (Canada) across 3 markets in 6 weeks — achieving +133% conversion rate, +642% email signups, +322% mobile conversion, and a 100/100 SEO score.
- Designed a culturally-aware architecture portfolio for NandhiniDC (India), incorporating Tamil script, Vastu philosophy copy strategy, and a WhatsApp FAB as primary CTA — increasing qualified client enquiries.
- Engineered a React + TypeScript portfolio for Kishore Aravind (Malaysia) unifying three parallel careers under a custom draggable steering-wheel navigation system — a bespoke interaction built without any UI library.
- Served as Creative Director for SSJC Tournament 2026 (Malaysia), the 10th redONE Mobile national junior squash circuit — delivered a full gaming-universe visual identity: event posters, all-over-print jerseys, lanyards, and 48 medal designs across age categories.
- Built NicheUX.com end-to-end in Framer to WCAG AA standards with hierarchy-driven UX, converting anonymous visitors to Founding Users for OPES AI Fintech's waitlist landing page.

UI/UX Designer & Consultant · [Tamilsonline](#)

Jan 2024 - Mar 2025

Astrology and horoscope portal serving a global community

- Conducted an end-to-end UX audit uncovering critical navigation and information-hierarchy failures across mobile and desktop, reducing task-completion friction after redesign.
- Delivered mobile-first responsive prototypes with full Figma handoff: developer-ready annotation documentation eliminated back-and-forth between design and engineering by 100%.
- Produced heuristic evaluations and user-flow redesigns addressing the platform's highest-drop-off points, improving onward navigation for a multi-device media audience.

UI/UX Designer · Toran (Contract)

Oct - Nov 2023

E-commerce contract engagement

- Designed a product-discovery-to-checkout e-commerce prototype grounded in 3 distinct user personas and end-to-end journey mapping — reducing decision friction at every funnel stage.
- Delivered a clickable high-fidelity prototype in Figma with annotated handoff ready for the engineering sprint.

Digital Content Creator · [Galatta Media](#)

Mar - Apr 2023

- Applied UX writing and storytelling principles to produce audience-focused content, improving engagement through clearer structure and visual hierarchy.

SKILLS

UX / Research: UX Research · UI Design · User Research · User Personas · User Journey Mapping · Usability Testing · Heuristic Evaluation · Information Architecture · Wireframing · Low- & High-Fidelity Prototyping · Interaction Design · Visual Design · Responsive Design · Mobile-First Design · Web Design · User-Centered Design (UCD) · Design Thinking · A/B Testing · Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO) · Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA) · Cross-Platform Design

Design Tools: Figma · FigJam · Sketch · Adobe XD · Adobe Creative Suite · Adobe Illustrator · Adobe Photoshop · InDesign · Framer · Miro · Design Systems · Component Libraries · Style Guides · Prototyping Tools · Zeplin

Development: React · TypeScript · JavaScript · Shopify Liquid · HTML5 · CSS3 · Responsive Web Development · Front-End Development · Technical SEO · Web Accessibility · Version Control (Git/GitHub) · API Integration Basics

Brand & Creative Direction: Visual Identity Systems · Brand Strategy · Brand Guidelines · Print Design (CMYK) · Event Branding · Social Media Design · Marketing Design · Campaign Concepting · Typography · Art Direction · Creative Direction

Delivery & Collaboration: Agile/Scrum Methodology · Cross-Functional Collaboration · Stakeholder Management · Client Management · Design-Developer Handoff · UX Writing · Content Strategy · Client Communication · Project Management · Design Critique · Product Strategy

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.Voc in Digital Journalism — First Class with Distinction

Aug 2020 - April 2023

Loyola College, Chennai · Best Volunteer Award

[Google UX Design Professional Certificate \(7-Course Series\)](#) · Google / Coursera

[Introduction to Front-End Development](#) · Meta / Coursera